COMBAT PATROL — HORUS HERESY (30K)

THE UNSPEAKABLE RITE

WORD BEARERS (HH, TRAITOR) | WARHAMMER 40,000 | 11TH EDITION

Erebus leads a Procurators line squad forward while the Gal Vorbak wait to be unleashed on whatever the Legion decides has earned their attention, and an Ashen Circle cadre drops in first to burn a path for all of them. The Unspeakable Rite is a fully homebrew Combat Patrol for the Word Bearers (XVII Legion) faction — a Horus Heresy-era Traitor Legion warband adapted to the Warhammer 40,000 11th-edition Combat Patrol framework, built entirely from the real HH3e Word Bearers roster (Erebus, Gal Vorbak, Procurators, Ashen Circle). Formatted to match the No Figure Left Behind Combat Patrol archive. Approx. 575pts at minimum squad size — Lorgar Aurelian is deliberately excluded, a Primarch's points cost alone exceeds this box's budget. **11e Space Marine codex update (18 Oct 2026):** datasheets brought in line with their updated standalone cards (power armour T5, Terminators T6, Astartes bolt weapons S5 AP-1 with [CLOSE-QUARTERS] pistols, codex weapon profiles). Current card points: Erebus 135, Gal Vorbak 235 / 460, Procurators 90 / 160, Ashen Circle 115 / 205.

ARMY RULE

EVERY WORD IS A WEAPON

Each time a friendly Word Bearers unit destroys the last model in an enemy unit in the Fight phase, until the end of the battle, that unit's Leadership characteristic cannot be modified to be worse than 6+.

DETACHMENT RULE

WORD BEARERS — GLORIOUS MARTYRDOM

Detachment Points: To use this detachment you must spend 1 DP.

Every company keeps at least one believer willing to stand in the way of the bullet meant for someone else. Once per battle, each time an enemy unit is selected to shoot a friendly Word Bearers unit, before any Hit rolls are made, you can select one model in that Word Bearers unit: until that attack has been fully resolved, all wounds allocated by that attack must be allocated to the selected model.

FORCE DISPOSITIONS

This detachment has access to the following Force Disposition: Take and Hold.

PATROL CONTENTS

- **1 Erebus** (1 model)
- **1 Gal Vorbak** (5 models)
- **1 Procurators** (5 models)
- **1 Ashen Circle** (5 models)

ENHANCEMENTS

FIRST OF THE FAITHFUL — *Erebus model only*

Each time this model's unit takes a Battle-shock test, that test is automatically passed.

BLOOD OF THE COVENANT — *Gal Vorbak unit only*

Each time a model in this unit is destroyed, until the end of the phase, add 1 to the Attacks characteristic of this unit's melee weapons.

STRATAGEMS

HYMN OF HATE **1CP**

Word Bearers — Battle Tactic Stratagem

When: Your Shooting phase, just after a friendly Word Bearers unit is selected to shoot.

Target: That unit.

Effect: Until the end of the phase, ranged weapons equipped by models in that unit have the [LETHAL HITS] ability.

BLESSED GROUND **1CP**

Word Bearers — Strategic Ploy Stratagem

When: Your Command phase.

Target: One friendly Word Bearers unit wholly within your own deployment zone.

Effect: Until your next Command phase, that unit has the Benefit of Cover.

NOTHING IS FORGIVEN **1CP**

Word Bearers — Battle Tactic Stratagem

When: Fight phase, just after a friendly Word Bearers unit is destroyed.

Target: The enemy unit that destroyed it.

Effect: That enemy unit suffers 3 mortal wounds.

MISSION

Consecrate in Blood

No Figure Left Behind homebrew mission. GW has not published a mission for this patrol.

Before the battle: Select one **expansion objective**. That is the ritual site.

SECOND BATTLE ROUND ONWARDS	
When: End of your Command phase (or the end of your turn in the fifth battle round).	
You control the ritual site.	**10VP**

ANY BATTLE ROUND	
When: End of your turn.	
An enemy unit within range of the ritual site was destroyed this or last turn.	**5VP**

DATASHEETS

EREBUS

M	T	SV	W	LD	OC
7"	5	2+	3	6+	2

Invulnerable Save: 4+

RANGED WEAPONS

WEAPON	RANGE	A	BS	S	AP	D
Plasma Pistol	12"	1	2+	7	-2	1

MELEE WEAPONS

WEAPON	RANGE	A	WS	S	AP	D
Crux Malifica	Melee	3	2+	7	-2	2

ABILITIES

Plasma Pistol
[CLOSE-QUARTERS]

Crux Malifica
[PSYCHIC]. Each time this weapon damages a unit, until the end of the battle, subtract 1 from that unit's Strength characteristic (this can only happen once per unit).

Warlord
If this model is your Warlord, once per battle, in your Command phase, you can gain 1 Command Point.

UNIT COMPOSITION

1 Erebus model. Equipped with: 1 Plasma Pistol; 1 Crux Malifica.

Keywords: INFANTRY, CHARACTER, EPIC HERO, PSYKER, EREBUS

Faction Keywords: LEGIONES ASTARTES, WORD BEARERS

GAL VORBAK

M	T	SV	W	LD	OC
7"	5	3+	2	7+	1

RANGED WEAPONS

WEAPON	RANGE	A	BS	S	AP	D
Bolter	24"	2	3+	5	-1	1

MELEE WEAPONS

WEAPON	RANGE	A	WS	S	AP	D
Tainted Talons	Melee	3	3+	5	-3	1

ABILITIES

Bolter
[RAPID FIRE 1]

Tainted Talons
[PSYCHIC] [DEVASTATING WOUNDS] [ANTI-VEHICLE 6+]. Each time this weapon damages a unit, until the end of the battle, subtract 1 from that unit's Strength characteristic (this can only happen once per unit).

Feel No Pain
[FEEL NO PAIN 5+]

Fear
Each time an enemy unit within 6" of this unit takes a Battle-shock test, that test is taken with a -1 modifier.

Implacable Advance
This unit cannot be selected to make a Fall Back move, and ignores modifiers to its Movement characteristic.

UNIT COMPOSITION

5 or 10 models. All models are equipped with a Bolter and a Tainted Talons.

Keywords: INFANTRY, DAEMON, GAL VORBAK

Faction Keywords: LEGIONES ASTARTES, WORD BEARERS

PROCURATORS

M	T	SV	W	LD	OC
7"	5	3+	1	7+	2

RANGED WEAPONS

WEAPON	RANGE	A	BS	S	AP	D
Bolt Pistol	12"	1	3+	5	-1	1

MELEE WEAPONS

WEAPON	RANGE	A	WS	S	AP	D
Chainsword	Melee	4	3+	5	-1	1

ABILITIES

Bolt Pistol
[CLOSE-QUARTERS]

Narthecium
Each time a model in this unit is destroyed, roll one D6: on a 6, that model is not destroyed and instead is returned to the unit with 1 wound remaining.

UNIT COMPOSITION

5 or 10 models: 1 Procurator and 4-9 Procurants. All models are equipped with a Bolt Pistol and a Chainsword.

Keywords: INFANTRY, BATTLELINE, PROCURATORS

Faction Keywords: LEGIONES ASTARTES, WORD BEARERS

ASHEN CIRCLE

M	T	SV	W	LD	OC
12"	5	3+	1	7+	2

RANGED WEAPONS

WEAPON	RANGE	A	BS	S	AP	D
Akkadic Hand Flamer	12"	D6	N/A	4	-1	1

MELEE WEAPONS

WEAPON	RANGE	A	WS	S	AP	D
Axe-Rake	Melee	2	3+	5	-3	1

ABILITIES

Akkadic Hand Flamer
[TORRENT] [PISTOL] [IGNORES COVER] — auto-hits, which is why it has no BS characteristic.

Axe-Rake
[LETHAL HITS]. Each time this weapon damages a unit, until the end of the battle, subtract 1" from that unit's Movement characteristic (this can only happen once per unit).

Core
[DEEP STRIKE]

UNIT COMPOSITION

5 or 10 models: 1 Iconoclast and 4-9 Incendiary. All models are equipped with an Akkadic Hand Flamer and an Axe-Rake.

Keywords: INFANTRY, JUMP PACK, DEEP STRIKE, ASHEN CIRCLE

Faction Keywords: LEGIONES ASTARTES, WORD BEARERS